

The Fortune Is In the Follow-Up. Capture the 50%.

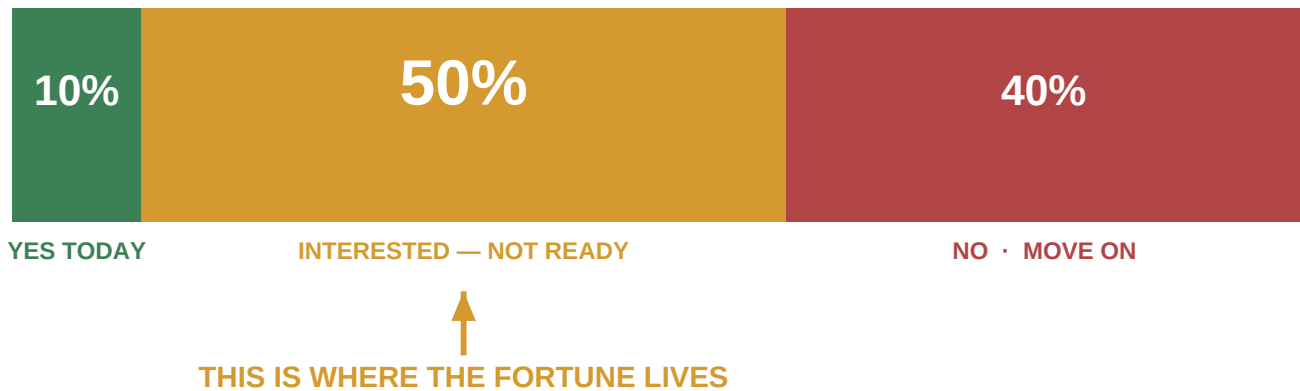
10% close today. 40% are gone. 50% are interested but not ready — and they're where the real money lives.

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Most reps optimise for the 10%. The 50% is the real prize.
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Coins distributed across the year. Keep walking forward.
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Print and pin.

The 10 / 50 / 40 split.

Across a typical day on the phone, this is how the calls actually break down. The 50% is the prize most reps walk past.



WHY THE 50% IS A 5X OPPORTUNITY

01 Optimising for the 10% caps you at 10%

You can only convert what's in front of you. If your strategy targets only same-day yeses, your conversion is bound by the smallest bucket.

02 Capturing half of the 50% adds 25%

A 25% lift on the same daily activity. That's roughly a 2.5x improvement — without making more calls.

03 The 40% don't get better

Stop relitigating the no. Mark them done. Save the energy for the 50%.

04 Most reps walk past it

Because they can't see today's spreadsheet improve. The 50% pays in months 3, 6, 9 — not today.

The 12-month mindset.

Pipeline only compounds if your horizon is long enough to harvest it. Pick a horizon. Commit to it.

SHORT HORIZON

*"I'll see how it goes." "Today is what matters."
"I need the deal this week."*

WHAT IT PRODUCES:

- Commission breath on every call
- Anxiety on the 90% who aren't ready today
- Pipeline stays empty — no time to build it
- Energy drops with every "call me in 3 months"
- Burnout in three to six months

12-MONTH HORIZON

*"I'm here for the year. Every conversation is a
seed for sometime in the next 12 months."*

WHAT IT PRODUCES:

- Big energy on every call
- Excitement when buyers say "3 months"
- Pipeline fills naturally
- Compound conversion in months 3, 6, 9
- Sustainable performance

THE COMMITMENT

Pick the horizon honestly. 12 months is best. 6 months is fine. 3 months is the floor. Below that — the pipeline can't compound.

The follow-up sequence.

Three steps. Permission → send → two-week call. Each one earns the right to the next.

GET PERMISSION TO SEND

01

On the first call. "Would you be upset if I sent you some interesting findings?" The 'upset' framing makes refusal feel melodramatic.

SEND IMMEDIATELY

02

While the buyer is still warm. Include something specific — ideally a critique of their current provider that creates curiosity.

BOOK THE TWO-WEEK FOLLOW-UP

03

"Would you be upset if I touched base in two weeks?" Two weeks is the magic number — close enough to be real, far enough to feel safe.

THE PATTERN

Permission is the foundation. The hand grenade (competitor critique) creates curiosity. The two-week cadence keeps the relationship warm without pressure.

"Would you be upset if...?"

The phrasing that makes refusal feel melodramatic — so almost no one refuses.

THE FORMULA

"Would you be upset if I [sent you something / touched base / followed up in two weeks]?" Said warmly. Followed by silence.

WHY IT WORKS

01 "Upset" is precious

Most buyers won't choose to be cast as the precious party. Saying yes to the follow-up is the easy choice — it requires no emotional defence.

02 It signals genuine care

The phrasing implies the rep would actually mind upsetting the buyer. That care lowers the buyer's defences.

03 It moves the decision from yes/no to upset/not-upset

A different decision in the buyer's mind. "No" sounds harsh. "Not upset" sounds easy. The buyer takes the easy path.

04 Either answer is useful

If they say "no, I would be upset" — they were never converting. If they say "no, of course not" — you're in. Both filter the pipeline.

The two-week rule.

Two weeks beats one week (feels pushy). Two weeks beats one month (feels distant). It's the calibrated number.



WHY TWO WEEKS IS THE NUMBER

01 Long enough that defences stay down

The buyer doesn't feel pursued. They feel respected. Their objection ("not now") has been accepted, not contested.

02 Short enough that the conversation stays warm

Two weeks later, the buyer remembers the prior call. The report is still relevant. The rep is still a known quantity.

03 Buyers say yes without thinking

"Sure, two weeks works." There's no negotiation, no pushback, no defensive calendar-check. Two weeks reads as casual.

04 It compounds

Two-week touchpoints over three months = six contacts. By the time the contract runs out, the rep is not a cold caller — they're the rep the buyer already knows.

Mario Brothers pipeline.

Coins distributed evenly across 365 days. Keep walking forward. They don't appear if you stop.

THE METAPHOR

Sales isn't a sprint to a finish line. It's a 365-day platform game. Coins are distributed evenly through the level — you collect them by walking forward, consistently, every day.

WHAT SLOW-BURN PIPELINE LOOKS LIKE

01 Top up the pipeline daily

Even when next month looks full. Especially when next month looks full. The drop-off comes from coasting.

02 Every "3 months" is a future deal logged

Not a loss. A reservation. Treat it as one.

03 Track against a 12-month horizon

Weekly conversion is volatile. Quarterly conversion is the real signal. Annual conversion is the truth.

04 The end state — your week is already full

Three months from now, every day of your calendar has a couple of warm deals already loaded. Today's booking isn't urgent — it's just topping up tomorrow's pipeline.

Daily reference card.

Print and pin. Read at the start of every day.

DO · EVERY DAY

- Treat every call as one of many — not the only one.
- Use "would you be upset if" on every follow-up ask.
- Get permission to send something on the first call.
- Use the two-week rule for re-contact.
- Include a competitor critique in the report.
- Track your 10/50/40 split.
- Fall on the sword — give the buyer a genuine opt-out.
- Top up the pipeline daily.

DON'T · EVER

- Don't write off "call me in 3 months."
- Don't ask "can I call you?" — too binary.
- Don't follow up at one week — too pushy.
- Don't follow up at one month — too distant.
- Don't take buyer enthusiasm at face value.
- Don't optimise for the 10%.
- Don't listen to the ghost telling you it's a waste.
- Don't coast when next month looks full.

WATCH-OUTS

- Commission breath on calls — buyers can hear it.
- The ghost talking you out of follow-up.
- Buyers who say "you're amazing" with no action.
- Reps who confuse activity for pipeline.
- Short horizons that prevent pipeline building.
- Follow-up reports without specific critique.
- Calendar choices that anchor the buyer to NOW.
- Two-week follow-ups that quietly drift to a month.

THE ONE-LINER

close today. 50% close later. The 50% is the fortune. Capture it with permission, curiosity, and two w